

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

This article appeared in a newspaper in Hong Kong:

Tattoo you?	And did you know the legal age for all these?	
It is currently illegal for those under 18 to get tattooed unless the tattoo is performed "for medical reasons by a registered medical practitioner". This means that even with your parents' permission, a tattoo artist cannot mark a person under 18. Still, this rule hasn't stopped some teenagers from getting tattoos in illegal shops.	Activity	Legal age
The trend for tattoos amongst youngsters has encouraged many teenagers to seek tattoos by non-legal means before they reach 18. Anushka Purohit, 15, says: "Tattoos make you look cooler, not scary, all my classmates want one."	Working age	13
	Marriage	16 (with parents' agreement)
	Category III film / Driving / Smoking / Tattoo	18
	Working in factories	15
	Being at home alone	16
However, a representative of a Hong Kong school says that students "lack the maturity" to make these kinds of decisions, not to mention that it is against the law.	Election candidates / Driving large trucks	21
Ross Turpin, a tattoo artist, urges youngsters not to get inked at such a young age. "Most ideas and fads that become internet sensations will fade in time and clients might later regret getting those tattoos."		

Your class has been asked to discuss whether the various legal ages are suitable. You may want to talk about:

- why the government has age limits for people getting tattoos
- why the age limits differ for different activities
- whether any age limits should be changed
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like tattoos?
2. Why is it dangerous for young people to be home alone?
3. When do you think is the best age to get married?
4. What type of tattoo do you think people will regret the most?
5. What do you think is worse: underage smoking or underage driving?
6. Do you think most people obey the legal ages in Hong Kong?
7. Do you think the government should give more responsibility to teenagers?
8. What age do you think people become adults?